

ELEMENT CONVENTIONS · 2026

Trailing element registers.

Four markdown shapes, one canonical order, the bottom of every slide.

The four registers, composed by markdown shape.

Key Insight

`> blockquote` — the observation. Accent-tinted panel with "KEY INSIGHT" eyebrow.

Below-Note

Plain `<p>` — context. Gradient hairline above body text.

Call-to-Action

`**bold**` -only `<p>` — the ask. Accent `▶` glyph before heading-color bold text.

Annotation

`_italic_` -only `<p>` — the citation. Accent `✦` glyph before muted small text.

KEY INSIGHT

The shape of the markdown picks the register. Selectors are mostly shape-based; the author's only job is canonical order.

Blockquote at the end of a slide becomes a Key Insight panel.

The contract

One trailing `> blockquote` per slide.

The shape

Accent-tinted bar, "KEY INSIGHT" eyebrow, body text in the heading color.

The signal

"Here is the summary that ties the slide together."

The exception

`quote` and `featured` layouts own the blockquote for primary content.

KEY INSIGHT

The blockquote summarises; everything else extends. Reach for it when the slide needs a single sentence the room remembers.

A trailing plain paragraph becomes a Below-Note.

The contract

One trailing plain `<p>` after the card content.

The shape

Gradient accent hairline above, body-size text.

The signal

"Context that frames the cards without summarising them."

The neighbours

Goes between the Key Insight (above it) and the Call-to-Action (below it).

This is a below-note. It pins a single line of context under the cards with a hairline drawn above — visually separate from the card content but not a summary.

Build vs. buy: build.

BUILD

Three engineers, eight weeks, owns the data path end-to-end.

WHY NOT BUY

Vendor lock-in on a hot-path primitive we cannot tune.

WHY NOT DELAY

Roadmap commitments slip past Q3, downstream teams stall.

► Approve scoping spike by Friday.

A trailing italic-only paragraph becomes an Annotation.

The contract

One trailing `<p>` whose only child is `_italic_`.

The shape

Accent `♦` glyph, then label-size muted text, lower hierarchy than below-note.

The signal

"Skim this, don't dwell — source, scope, caveat, asterisk."

The neighbours

Last in the trailing block, after any Call-to-Action.

♦ *Source: pilot retrospective, six months across four product teams.*

All four registers can compose on one slide.

Key Insight

Blockquote — first of the trailing block.

Below-Note

Plain paragraph — second, the context line.

Call-to-Action

paragraph — third, the ask.

Annotation

paragraph — fourth, the citation.

KEY INSIGHT

Four registers, one canonical order — Key Insight first, Annotation last.

Use all four sparingly — a slide carrying summary plus context plus ask plus citation is doing too much.

Pick the two registers that close the argument cleanly.

Lattice element conventions, May 2026 — see <docs/references/templates.md> § Trailing Element Registers.

Author trailing registers in canonical order.

The CLI render path composes any order cleanly. The Marp-preview path is position-sensitive — out-of-order trailing registers silently lose the hairline above the first one. Canonical order keeps both paths in agreement.

`docs/references/templates.md` § Trailing Element Registers

`docs/references/gotchas.md` § Trailing register out of canonical order